IELTS SPEAKING • TOPIC 13

HISTORICAL BUILDINGS

Natural collocations • Advanced grammar structures • Sample answer

PART 1 • QUESTIONS

- Are there old buildings in your hometown?
- Do you prefer old or modern buildings?
- Have you visited any famous buildings?

PART 2 • CUE CARD

Describe a historical building in your country.

You should say:

- where it is
- what it looks like
- what its history is
- why it is important

PART 3 • QUESTIONS

- Why should old buildings be preserved?
- Who should pay for their maintenance?
- How does tourism help or harm historical sites?

50	12	62	124
collocations	structures	Band 8 stories	your sentences

START HERE

One plan for every “historical buildings” card

A historical building you have visited

A famous monument in your country

An old building you would like to visit

A place of historical interest you enjoyed

A building that has changed over time

An old house or mosque in your area

A museum or palace you have been to

A historical place you would recommend to a friend

Where it is → **What** it looks like → **History** what happened there → **Why** it matters to you

HOW TO READ EACH CARD

Tarjima + definition — o‘zbekcha ma’nosi va oddiy inglizcha izohi.

Band 8 story — iborani ro‘yxat emas, mini hikoya ichida ishlatish namunasi.

≈ Yaqin iboralar — shu ma’noga yaqin yana 2 ta natural ibora.

Qachon ishlatiladi — qaysi vaziyatda va qanday grammatika bilan.

Namuna gap — bitta tayyor gap. Keyin o‘zingiz 2 ta gap yozing.

Speaking ball — shu ibora gapirishda qanchalik foydali (10 dan).

10 / 10	Signature ibora: Band 8 ni ko‘rsatadi, ko‘p topiclarda ishlaydi.
8–9	Kuchli va moslashuvchan: tabiiy eshitiladi, ball oshiradi.
6–7	Foydali va ishonchli: asos sifatida yaxshi.
4–5	Vaziyatga bog‘liq yoki oddiyroq: faqat mos kelganda ishlating.

Describing the building

COLLOCATIONS 1 / 5

1 an architectural masterpiece

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

me'moriy durdona, mo'jiza asar • *a building so well designed that people admire it as a work of art*

BAND 8 STORY

The first time I saw the Registan in Samarkand, I just stood there in silence. It's **an architectural masterpiece**, and every time I bring a foreign friend there, they say the same thing.

≈ **a feat of architecture** — me'morchilikning ulkan yutug'i

≈ **a work of art** — san'at asari

Qachon ishlatiladi: Binoni maqtash uchun Part 2 da ishlating: be + an architectural masterpiece. Ko'plikda ham bo'ladi: architectural masterpieces. 'Very beautiful building' o'rniga ayting.

Namuna gap: The Registan is **an architectural masterpiece** that no photo can truly capture.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 intricate tilework

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

murakkab, nafis koshinkori • *very detailed and complicated patterns made of small tiles*

BAND 8 STORY

What amazed me most inside the madrasa was the **intricate tilework** covering every wall. I spent twenty minutes just looking at one small panel, wondering how craftsmen did it without modern tools.

≈ **delicate mosaics** — nozik mozaikalar

≈ **elaborate patterns** — murakkab naqshlar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Koshinkori, naqsh va o'ymakorlikni tasvirlashda: intricate + tilework/carvings/patterns. 'Intricate' - juda mayda va murakkab detallar uchun, faqat 'big' narsalar uchun emas.

Namuna gap: The walls were covered in **intricate tilework** in shades of blue and turquoise.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 towering minarets

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

baland minoralar • *very tall, impressive towers next to a mosque or madrasa*

BAND 8 STORY

As our bus came round the corner in Bukhara, the **towering minarets** suddenly appeared above the rooftops. My little brother pointed at them and shouted, and honestly, I felt like shouting too.

≈ **soaring spires** — osmonga ko'tarilgan minoralar

≈ **a skyline of domes** — gumbazlar siluet

Qachon ishlatiladi: Baland binolarni tasvirlashda 'towering' ishlating: towering walls/minarets/gates. Faqat tashqi ko'rinish haqida; Part 2 dagi 'what it looks like' bandi uchun juda mos.

Namuna gap: Visitors are often struck by the **towering minarets** that dominate the old town.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 an imposing structure

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

salobatli, hayratga soladigan bino • *a large building that looks powerful and impressive*

BAND 8 STORY

From the outside, the fortress is **an imposing structure** with thick walls and a heavy wooden gate. As a child, I was almost scared of it, but once I got inside, I found a peaceful garden.

≈ **a grand building** — ulug‘vor bino

≈ **a commanding presence** — salobat, ta‘sirchan ko‘rinish

Qachon ishlatiladi: Katta, kuchli taassurot qoldiradigan bino (qal‘a, saroy) uchun. ‘Imposing‘ ijobiy yoki neytral; ‘scary‘ ma’nosida emas. Part 2 da ‘what it looks like‘ uchun yaxshi.

Namuna gap: The citadel is **an imposing structure** that dominates the whole skyline.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 steeped in history

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

tarixga boy, tarix bilan chambarchas bog‘liq • *having a very long and interesting history*

BAND 8 STORY

Khiva is a town that is completely **steeped in history**. Walking through the narrow streets at dusk, I could almost imagine merchants arriving with their camels after a long journey on the Silk Road.

≈ **rich in history** — tarixga boy

≈ **with a long past** — uzoq o‘tmishga ega

Qachon ishlatiladi: Joy yoki bino haqida: be steeped in history/tradition. ‘Steeped in‘ dan keyin faqat history, tradition, culture kabi so‘zlar keladi. Juda kuchli, har mavzuda ishlaydi.

Namuna gap: Our city is **steeped in history**, and you can feel it on almost every street.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 a stunning façade

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

ajoyib old tomon (fasad) • *a very beautiful front wall of a building*

BAND 8 STORY

The mausoleum has **a stunning façade** decorated with blue and gold patterns. I went at sunrise, when the light hit the tiles, and I took so many photos that my phone ran out of memory.

≈ **an eye-catching exterior** — e’tiborni tortadigan tashqi ko‘rinish

≈ **a striking front** — ta‘sirchan old devor

Qachon ishlatiladi: Binoning tashqi ko‘rinishi uchun: a stunning/impressive/elegant façade. ‘Façade‘ so‘zida c ostida belgi bor, lekin ‘facade‘ deb yozish ham mumkin. Talaffuz: /fəˈsɑːd/.

Namuna gap: The hotel has kept **a stunning façade** from the 19th century.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 well-preserved

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

yaxshi saqlangan • *kept in very good condition for a long time*

BAND 8 STORY

I was surprised how **well-preserved** the old caravanserai was. The ceiling still had its original wooden beams, and I could easily picture traders resting there hundreds of years ago.

≈ **in excellent condition** — a'lo holatda

≈ **remarkably intact** — hayratlanarli darajada butun

Qachon ishlatiladi: Qadimiy bino yoki buyum haqida sifat sifatida: a well-preserved fortress / remarkably well-preserved. 'Old' o'rniga ishlatsangiz, so'zingiz boyroq bo'ladi.

Namuna gap: The fortress is **well-preserved**, so you can still walk along the original walls.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 ornate decoration

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

bezakdor, hashamatli bezak • *decoration with a lot of detailed, fancy patterns*

BAND 8 STORY

Inside the palace, every ceiling had **ornate decoration** in gold and red. My grandmother, who rarely gets impressed, simply whispered, 'Subhanallah,' and walked slowly from room to room.

≈ **lavish interiors** — hashamatli ichki bezak

≈ **rich ornamentation** — boy naqshlar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ichki bezak va naqshlarni tasvirlash uchun: ornate decoration/ceilings/carvings. 'Ornate' - haddan tashqari bezakli ma'nosi ham bor, shuning uchun ko'pincha ijobiy kontekstda.

Namuna gap: The ballroom is full of **ornate decoration**, from the ceiling to the floor.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 a turquoise dome

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

firuza gumbaz • *a round roof with a bright blue-green colour*

BAND 8 STORY

From my uncle's rooftop in Samarkand, you can see **a turquoise dome** shining against the sky. When the sun goes down, it turns almost purple, and that's the moment I always wait for with my camera.

≈ **a blue-tiled dome** — ko'k koshinli gumbaz

≈ **a glittering dome** — yaltirab turgan gumbaz

Qachon ishlatiladi: Aniq, 'ko'rinadigan' tasvir berish uchun rang + noun: a turquoise dome / a golden minaret. Bu sizning Band 8 hikoyangizga jonli detal qo'shadi.

Namuna gap: The mausoleum is topped with **a turquoise dome** that you can spot from miles away.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 a living museum

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

jonli muzey • *a place that still shows history in everyday life*

BAND 8 STORY

Itchan Kala in Khiva feels like **a living museum**, because families still live in the old houses. I loved buying bread from a woman who baked it in the same kind of oven her ancestors used.

≈ **an open-air museum** — ochiq osmon ostidagi muzey

≈ **a time capsule** — vaqt kapsulasi, o‘tmish saqlangan joy

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hali ham odamlar yashaydigan tarixiy joy uchun. ‘a living museum’ ni shaharni tasvirlashda ishlating; ‘a time capsule’ esa o‘zgarmay qolgan joyga mos.

Namuna gap: The old quarter is **a living museum** where locals go about their daily lives.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 date back to

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ga borib taqaladi, ... dan beri bor • *to have existed since a certain time in the past*

BAND 8 STORY

The old mosque near our mahalla **dates back to** the 15th century. My grandfather loves telling us that the same families have prayed there for more than five hundred years.

≈ **go back to** — ... ga borib taqaladi

≈ **originate from** — ... dan kelib chiqqan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Binoning yoshini aytganda: date back to + century/year yoki date from. Present Simple da ishlating: 'It dates back to...' ('It dated' emas). Part 2 'history' bandi uchun asosiy ibora.

Namuna gap: The fortress **dates back to** the 12th century and has survived many invasions.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 be commissioned by

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

... tomonidan buyurtma qilingan • *to be officially ordered or paid for by someone important*

BAND 8 STORY

The Gur-e-Amir was **commissioned by** Timur for his grandson, but sadly it became his own resting place too. I learned this from a guide, and it made the building feel much more personal to me.

≈ **be built at the request of** — ... iltimosi bilan qurilgan

≈ **be ordered by** — ... buyrug'i bilan qurilgan

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(fe'l) topshiriq bermoq, buyurtma bermoq (rassom, qo'shiq) — The city **commissioned** a famous artist to paint a mural.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Binoni kim qurdirganini aytish uchun passiv: was commissioned by + hukmdor/arxitektor. Qurilish tarixi haqida gapirganda professional eshitiladi.

Namuna gap: The palace was **commissioned by** a local ruler who wanted to show his power.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

13 fall into disrepair

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

buzilib, yaroqsiz holga kelmoq • *to become damaged because nobody looks after it*

BAND 8 STORY

After the 1960s, the old bathhouse **fell into disrepair**, and its roof started leaking. Locals were heartbroken, so they collected money, and today it's a lovely small museum.

≈ **go to ruin** — vayronaga aylanmoq

≈ **become dilapidated** — chirimoq, eskirib qolmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Qarovsiz qolgan bino uchun: fall into disrepair / be in a state of disrepair. 'Ruin' dan yengilroq, hali tuzatish mumkin degan ma'noni beradi. Part 3 da ham foydali.

Namuna gap: Many beautiful houses **fell into disrepair** because owners couldn't afford repairs.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

14 restore to its former glory

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

eski ulug‘vorligini qaytarmoq • *to repair something so it looks as good as it did long ago*

BAND 8 STORY

When I was little, the madrasa near our school was almost a ruin. Then a team of craftsmen spent five years to **restore** it **to its former glory**, and now it’s the pride of our whole district.

≈ **bring back to life** — qayta jonlantirmoq

≈ **return to its original state** — asl holiga qaytarmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Eski binoni ta’mirlash haqida: restore + noun + to its former glory. Bu ibora Band 8 uchun tayyor, ko‘p mavzuda (shahar, mahalla, ko‘prik) ishlaydi.

Namuna gap: They managed to **restore** the old theatre **to its former glory** in just two years.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

15 bear witness to

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ga guvoh bo‘lmoq, dalil bo‘lmoq • *to show clearly that something happened in the past*

BAND 8 STORY

The scars on the fortress wall **bear witness to** the battles it has seen. I ran my hand over the old stones, and honestly, I got goosebumps thinking of the soldiers who stood there.

≈ **stand as proof of** — ... ning isboti bo‘lib turmoq

≈ **testify to** — ... ni tasdiqlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bino yoki joy tarixning ‘jim guvohi’ ekanini aytish uchun: X bears witness to Y. Rasmiyroq uslub, Part 2 va Part 3 da yaxshi, kundalik gapda kam.

Namuna gap: These ancient walls **bear witness to** centuries of change in our region.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

16 play a pivotal role in

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... da hal qiluvchi rol o‘ynamoq • *to be extremely important in making something happen*

BAND 8 STORY

The caravanserai **played a pivotal role in** the Silk Road trade, because merchants needed a safe place to sleep. When I stood in its courtyard, I could almost hear them bargaining over silk and spices.

≈ **play a key role in** — ... da asosiy rol o‘ynamoq

≈ **be instrumental in** — ... da muhim vosita bo‘lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: ‘Important’ o‘rniga: play a pivotal/crucial/vital role in + noun yoki -ing. Part 2 dagi ‘why it is important’ uchun va Part 3 dagi tushuntirishlar uchun ajoyib.

Namuna gap: Tourism **plays a pivotal role in** protecting historical buildings.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

17 survive earthquakes and invasions

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

zilzila va bosqinlardan omon qolmoq • *to continue to exist after terrible events*

BAND 8 STORY

What fascinates me about this minaret is that it has **survived earthquakes and invasions**, and it still stands. Our guide said the secret was the deep foundation, and I was honestly amazed that people knew that so long ago.

≈ **withstand natural disasters** — tabiiy ofatlarga bardosh bermoq

≈ **stand firm through wars** — urushlarga qaramay mustahkam turmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bino 'turg'un' ekanini ko'rsatadi: survive/withstand + earthquakes/floods/wars. 'Survive' to'g'ridan-to'g'ri object oladi (survive wars), 'survive from' demang.

Namuna gap: The tower has **survived earthquakes and invasions** for nearly nine hundred years.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

18 be rebuilt from scratch

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

noldan qayta qurilmoq • *to be built again completely, starting from nothing*

BAND 8 STORY

After the big earthquake in 1966, large parts of Tashkent had to **be rebuilt from scratch**. My grandfather remembers neighbours from many republics arriving to help, and he says that spirit mattered as much as the bricks.

≈ **be reconstructed** — qayta tiklanmoq

≈ **be built anew** — yangidan qurilmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(idiom) noldan boshlamoq — I lost my notes, so I had to start **from scratch**.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Butunlay yangidan qurish haqida: be rebuilt/redesigned/started from scratch. 'Restore' (ta'mirlash) bilan chalkashtirmang: from scratch hammasini nolinchi darajadan boshlashni bildiradi.

Namuna gap: The whole bridge had to **be rebuilt from scratch** after the flood.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

19 a window into the past

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o'tmishga ochilgan darcha • *something that helps you understand how people lived long ago*

BAND 8 STORY

For me, visiting the old merchant's house was **a window into the past**. The tiny rooms, the carved doors and the wooden stairs told me more about daily life than any textbook ever could.

≈ **a glimpse of history** — tarixga bir nazar

≈ **a peek into old times** — qadimgi zamonga bir ko'z tashlash

Qachon ishlatiladi: Muzey yoki bino sizga tarixni 'ko'rsatganini' aytish uchun: offer/provide a window into the past. 'Why it is important' bandida juda mos, 'glimpse' bilan ham almashtirsa bo'ladi.

Namuna gap: Old buildings give us **a window into the past** that books simply can't.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

20 pass down from generation to generation

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

avloddan avlodga o‘tmoq • *to give knowledge or traditions to your children and grandchildren*

BAND 8 STORY

The skill of making carved wooden doors has been **passed down from generation to generation** in our family. My uncle taught me the basics when I was ten, and I’m proud to be the next link in the chain.

≈ **hand down** — meros qilib qoldirmoq

≈ **be inherited through the ages** — asrlar davomida meros bo‘lib kelmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: An’ana, hunar va hikoyalar haqida: be passed down from generation to generation (passiv) yoki pass down + noun. ‘Pass down’ ning ikkinchi ma’nosi: o‘tkazib yubormoq emas, meros qoldirmoq.

Namuna gap: These stories have been **passed down from generation to generation** in our mahalla.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Feelings and reasons it matters (Part 2)

21 take my breath away

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

nafasimni qaytarib qo‘ymoq, hayratga solmoq • *to surprise and impress someone very much with beauty*

BAND 8 STORY

The moment I stepped into the courtyard of the Shah-i-Zinda complex, the colours **took my breath away**. I forgot about my tired legs and my phone, and I just stood there for a full minute.

≈ **blow me away** — hayratda qoldirmoq

≈ **leave me speechless** — tilimni bog‘lab qo‘ymoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Chiroyli manzara yoki bino haqida: The view took my breath away. ‘Take someone’s breath away’ - o‘tgan zamonda ‘took’ deb ishlating. Part 2 dagi ‘how you felt’ bandi uchun a’lo.

Namuna gap: The sunset over the old walls **took my breath away**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

22 leave a lasting impression

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

uzoq esda qoladigan taassurot qoldirmoq • *to make someone remember something for a very long time*

BAND 8 STORY

My first visit to Bukhara’s old town **left a lasting impression** on me. Even now, years later, I can still smell the fresh bread and hear the call to prayer echoing between the domes.

≈ **make a deep impression** — chuqur taassurot qoldirmoq

≈ **stay with me for years** — yillar davomida yodimda qolmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tajriba yoki joy sizga qanchalik ta’sir qilganini aytish uchun: leave a lasting impression on + someone. ‘On’ predlogini unutmang. Part 2 xulosasida juda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: The visit **left a lasting impression** on everyone in my class.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

23 send shivers down my spine

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

tanamdan titroq o‘tkazmoq • *to make you feel excited or a little scared in a strong way*

BAND 8 STORY

Standing alone in the old fortress at dusk **sent shivers down my spine**. I imagined the soldiers who once guarded the same walls, and suddenly the quiet felt almost alive.

≈ **give me goosebumps** — badanimni junjiktirmoq

≈ **make my hair stand on end** — tuklarimni tikka qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Kuchli hissiyotni ko‘rsatadigan idiom: It sends shivers down my spine (hozirgi zamon) yoki sent (o‘tgan). Rasmiy insho (essay) da emas, og‘zaki nutqda ishlating.

Namuna gap: Hearing the guide describe the siege **sent shivers down my spine**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

24 transport you back in time

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

sizni o‘tmishga olib ketmoq • *to make you feel as if you are living in an earlier age*

BAND 8 STORY

Walking along the narrow lanes of old Khiva really **transports you back in time**. With no cars around and clay walls on both sides, I felt like I was part of a historical film.

≈ **take you back centuries** — sizni asrlar orqaga qaytarmoq

≈ **bring history to life** — tarixni jonlantirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Qadimiy joyning muhitini tasvirlash uchun: X transports you back in time. ‘You’ umumiy ma’noda ishlatiladi. ‘Bring history to life’ esa muzey, gid yoki filmlar uchun mos.

Namuna gap: Stepping into the old bathhouse **transported me back in time**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

25 feel a deep connection to

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ga chuqur bog‘liqlik his qilmoq • *to feel strongly linked to a place, person or past*

BAND 8 STORY

Whenever I visit the mausoleum where my ancestors are buried, I **feel a deep connection to** my roots. It reminds me that I’m part of a very long story, not just a person on a phone.

≈ **feel a strong bond with** — ... bilan mustahkam rishta his qilmoq

≈ **feel rooted in** — ildizimni his qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Joy yoki o‘tmish bilan hissiy aloqani aytish uchun: feel a deep connection to/with + noun. ‘To‘ dan keyin -ing emas, ot keladi. Part 2 dagi ‘why it is important’ uchun a’lo.

Namuna gap: I **feel a deep connection to** this building because my family comes from the area.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

26 a source of national pride

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

milliy g‘urur manbai • *something that makes a whole country feel proud*

BAND 8 STORY

The Registan is **a source of national pride** for almost every Uzbek I know. When a foreign friend asked me where to go in my country, I didn’t even need a second to answer.

≈ **a symbol of our identity** — o‘z o‘ziligimiz ramzi

≈ **something we take pride in** — biz g‘ururlanadigan narsa

Qachon ishlatiladi: ‘Why it is important’ bandida ishlating: a source of national pride/inspiration/income. Kuchli, Band 8 darajasidagi ibora. ‘Take pride in’ fe’l shakli ham bor.

Namuna gap: The ancient observatory is **a source of national pride** for scientists here.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

27 part of our national identity

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

milliy o‘ziligimizning bir qismi • *something that makes a country feel like itself*

BAND 8 STORY

These old mosques and madrasas are **part of our national identity**. If we ever lost them, I think a piece of who we are would disappear as well, no matter how modern our cities become.

≈ **a cornerstone of our culture** — madaniyatimizning poydevori

≈ **a core part of who we are** — biz kimligimizning asosiy qismi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bino yoki an’ana nima uchun muhimligini aytganda: be part of our national identity/heritage. Part 3 da ‘why preserve old buildings’ savoliga javob sifatida juda mos.

Namuna gap: Old buildings are **part of our national identity**, so we can’t just knock them down.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

28 awe-inspiring

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

hayratga soladigan, ulug‘vor • *so impressive that you feel respect and wonder*

BAND 8 STORY

The size of the Bibi-Khanym Mosque is truly **awe-inspiring**. Next to its giant arch, I felt tiny, and I couldn’t stop thinking about the workers who built it without any machines.

≈ **jaw-dropping** — og‘zini ochirib qo‘yadigan

≈ **magnificent** — ulug‘vor, ajoyib

Qachon ishlatiladi: Katta, ta’sirli binolar uchun sifat: an awe-inspiring sight/view/monument. ‘Awesome’ kundalik so‘z, ‘awe-inspiring‘ esa ancha jiddiy va chiroyli eshitiladi.

Namuna gap: The sheer scale of the citadel is **awe-inspiring**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

29 soak up the atmosphere

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

muhitdan bahramand bo‘lmoq • *to enjoy the feeling and mood of a place*

BAND 8 STORY

After the tour, I didn’t rush to leave. I sat in a small chaikhana by the old gate, drank green tea and **soaked up the atmosphere** while the sun went down behind the minarets.

≈ **absorb the vibe** — muhitni his qilmoq

≈ **take it all in** — hammasini tomosha qilib bahra olmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(fe’l) shimib olmoq, so‘rib olmoq (suyuqlikni) — Use a towel to **soak up** the water on the floor.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Joyning ruhini his qilish haqida: soak up the atmosphere/sun/culture. ‘Soak up’ - faqat positiv tajriba uchun. Part 2 oxirida ‘how I felt’ ni ko‘rsatadi.

Namuna gap: We just sat on the steps and **soaked up the atmosphere** of the old square.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

30 bring history to life

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

tarixni jonlantirmoq • *to make the past feel real and exciting*

BAND 8 STORY

Our guide in Samarkand really **brought history to life**. Instead of listing dates, she told us short stories about the people who lived there, and the whole group listened as if it were a film.

≈ **make the past come alive** — o‘tmishni tirik qilmoq

≈ **breathe life into the past** — o‘tmishga jon bag‘ishlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Gid, muzey, kitob yoki film tarixni qiziqarli qilganini aytish uchun: X brings history to life. Part 2 va Part 3 (education) da ishlaydi.

Namuna gap: Good museums **bring history to life** with stories and interactive displays.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

31 a tourist hotspot

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

sayyohlar ko‘p boradigan mashhur joy • *a place that is very popular with visitors*

BAND 8 STORY
Since it became **a tourist hotspot**, the old town near my home has completely changed. There are new cafes and souvenir stalls everywhere, which is good for business but a bit noisy for locals.

≈ **a popular tourist destination** — mashhur turistik manzil

≈ **a magnet for visitors** — sayyohlarni o‘ziga tortadigan joy

Qachon ishlatiladi: Mashhur joyni tasvirlash uchun: become/be a tourist hotspot. ‘Spot’ so‘zi gapni jonli qiladi. Part 3 da turizm ta’siri haqida gapirganda ham ishlating.

Namuna gap: The fortress has become **a tourist hotspot** in the last decade.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

32 a must-see attraction

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

albatta ko‘rish kerak bo‘lgan joy • *a place that every visitor should see*

BAND 8 STORY
If you visit Tashkent, the old city is **a must-see attraction**. I tell all my foreign friends to go early in the morning, before the heat and the crowds arrive.

≈ **a top attraction** — eng yaxshi diqqatga sazovor joy

≈ **an unmissable sight** — qoldirib bo‘lmaydigan joy

Qachon ishlatiladi: Birovga maslahat berish uchun: X is a must-see (attraction/sight). ‘Must-see’ sifat sifatida ham, ot sifatida ham bo‘ladi. Part 1 da ‘famous buildings’ savoliga mos.

Namuna gap: The palace is **a must-see attraction** for anyone interested in history.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

33 take a guided tour

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

gid bilan ekskursiya qilmoq • *to visit a place with a person who explains it*

BAND 8 STORY
Last spring I decided to **take a guided tour** of the old fortress, and I’m so glad I did. Without our guide, I would have walked past the tiny carvings that tell the story of the whole place.

≈ **join a tour group** — sayohat guruhiga qo‘shilmoq

≈ **go on a walking tour** — piyoda ekskursiyaga chiqmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Joy bilan tanishish haqida: take/go on a guided tour of + place. ‘Of’ predlogi bilan ishlating. Part 1 ‘Have you visited famous buildings?’ savoliga javobda ham yaxshi.

Namuna gap: We decided to **take a guided tour** to learn the story behind each room.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

34 pay an entrance fee

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

kirish haqini to‘lamoq • *to pay money in order to go inside a place*

BAND 8 STORY

I remember being surprised that we had to **pay an entrance fee** just to walk into the courtyard. But then I saw the work needed to keep it clean and safe, and I understood why.

≈ **buy a ticket** — chipta sotib olmoq

≈ **be charged admission** — kirish uchun haq undirilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Kirish narxi haqida: pay an entrance fee/admission charge. Britaniya inglizchasida ‘entrance fee’ va ‘admission’ ikkalasi ham ishlatiladi. Part 3 da moliyalashtirish bahsida foydali.

Namuna gap: Visitors have to **pay an entrance fee**, which helps cover repairs.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

35 be swarming with tourists

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

sayyohlarga to‘lib ketmoq • *to be extremely crowded with visitors*

BAND 8 STORY

When we got to the square at noon, it **was swarming with tourists**. People were pushing for photos, and I could hardly see the building, so I promised myself to come back at sunrise.

≈ **be packed with visitors** — mehmonlar bilan gavjum bo‘lmoq

≈ **be jam-packed** — tiqilinch bo‘lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Juda gavjum joyni aytish uchun: be swarming/teeming with + ko‘p odam yoki hasharot. ‘Swarm’ so‘zi biroz salbiy ohangga ega, shuning uchun shikoyat hikoyalarida mos.

Namuna gap: The old market **was swarming with tourists** during the holiday.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

36 peak season

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

eng gavjum mavsum • *the busiest time of year for travel*

BAND 8 STORY

We visited in **peak season**, so the queues were endless and the hotel prices were crazy. Next time I’d go in early spring, when the weather is nice and the monuments are almost empty.

≈ **high season** — yuqori mavsum

≈ **busy period** — gavjum davr

Qachon ishlatiladi: Turizm haqida: in/during peak season, off-peak season (qarama-qarshi). ‘In the peak season’ yoki ‘in peak season’ ikkalasi to‘g‘ri. Part 3 turizm savollarida juda foydali.

Namuna gap: Prices go up sharply during **peak season**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

37 wander around

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

aylanib yurmoq, sayr qilmoq • *to walk slowly without a clear plan, just looking*

BAND 8 STORY

After the formal tour, I loved to **wander around** the side streets on my own. That's where I found a tiny workshop where an old man was still making ceramics by hand.

≈ **stroll around** — sekin aylanmoq

≈ **explore on foot** — piyoda kashf etmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(fe'l) chalg'imoq, mavzudan chetga chiqmoq — My mind started to **wander** during the long lecture.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Joyni erkin ko'rish uchun: wander around/through + place. 'Around' siz ham bo'ladi, lekin 'around' tabiiyroq. Part 2 da 'what I did there' uchun a'lo.

Namuna gap: I love to **wander around** old quarters with no map.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

38 off the beaten track

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

odamlar kam boradigan joyda • *in a place few people visit*

BAND 8 STORY

My favourite historical site is a small fortress **off the beaten track**, about two hours from Samarkand. There were no ticket booths, just a quiet hill and a sheep farmer who showed me around for free.

≈ **far from the crowds** — olomondan uzoqda

≈ **a hidden gem** — yashirin gavhar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Mashhur emas, lekin qiziq joylar haqida: off the beaten track yoki a hidden gem. Part 1 va 2 uchun yaxshi; 'beaten' so'zini 'beating' demang.

Namuna gap: The best sights are often **off the beaten track**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

39 souvenir stalls

5/10 SPEAKING BALL

esdalik do'konchalari • *small shops that sell gifts for visitors*

BAND 8 STORY

Right outside the gate, **souvenir stalls** sell little ceramic pots and silk scarves. I bought one for my mum, and the seller gave me a free cup of tea because I tried to speak a little English with him.

≈ **gift shops** — sovg'a do'konlari

≈ **craft stalls** — hunarmandchilik rastalari

Qachon ishlatiladi: Turistik joylar atrofini tasvirlash uchun: souvenir stalls/shops. Oddiy 'shops' o'rniga aniq so'z tanlash sizni Band 7+ ga yaqinlashtiradi.

Namuna gap: The square is lined with **souvenir stalls** selling local crafts.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

40 mass tourism

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

ommaviy turizm • *travel by very large numbers of people to popular places*

BAND 8 STORY

I worry that **mass tourism** will spoil some of our most beautiful sites. When too many people climb the same steps every day, the stone wears down, and the peaceful feeling disappears.

≈ **overtourism** — haddan ortiq turizm

≈ **crowds of visitors** — katta sayyohlar oqimi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Turizmning salbiy tomoni haqida Part 3 da: mass tourism puts pressure on sites. 'Mass' - 'ommaviy'. Ijobiy tomonini ham aytib, muvozanatli javob bering.

Namuna gap: **Mass tourism** can damage fragile buildings if it isn't managed well.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Part 3: preservation, money and tourism

COLLOCATIONS 5 / 5

41 preserve our cultural heritage

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

madaniy merosimizni asramoq • *to protect traditions and buildings from the past*

BAND 8 STORY

In my opinion, we have a duty to **preserve our cultural heritage**, because once a building disappears it can never come back. My grandfather often says that a country without a past is like a tree without roots.

≈ **safeguard our heritage** — merosimizni himoya qilmoq

≈ **protect our legacy** — merosimizni asrab qolmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da 'Why should old buildings be preserved?' savoliga: We should preserve our cultural heritage because... 'Preserve' + object, 'heritage' esa sanalmaydigan ot.

Namuna gap: It's vital to **preserve our cultural heritage** for future generations.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

42 conservation work

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

saqlash va ta'mirlash ishlari • *repairs and protection to keep an old building safe*

BAND 8 STORY

The government started **conservation work** on the old mosque last year, and I was impressed. Experts used traditional materials instead of cement, which keeps the building looking authentic.

≈ **restoration work** — tiklash ishlari

≈ **repair and maintenance** — ta'mirlash va saqlash

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tarixiy binolarni ta'mirlash haqida: carry out/fund conservation work. 'Conservation' - saqlash, 'restoration' - qayta tiklash: ikkalasi biroz farq qiladi.

Namuna gap: Expensive **conservation work** is often needed to keep old buildings from collapsing.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

43 public funding

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

davlat mablag'i • *money that comes from the government and taxes*

BAND 8 STORY

I believe old buildings need **public funding**, since they belong to everyone. Private owners might not want to spend millions on a roof that can't earn money, and that's how heritage gets lost.

≈ **government support** — davlat yordami

≈ **taxpayers' money** — soliq to'lovchilar puli

Qachon ishlatiladi: 'Who should pay?' savoliga javob uchun: rely on public funding / receive public funding. 'Funding' sanalmaydigan ot: 'a funding' demang. 'Fund' (fe'l) ham bor.

Namuna gap: Without **public funding**, many historical sites would fall apart.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

44 allocate funds to

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ga mablag‘ ajratmoq • *to officially decide to give money for a special purpose*

BAND 8 STORY

In my view, the government should **allocate** more **funds to** heritage projects rather than building another shopping centre. Hospitals matter more, of course, but culture deserves a fair share of the budget too.

≈ **set aside money for** — ... uchun pul ajratib qo‘ymoq

≈ **invest in** — ... ga sarmoya kiritmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Davlat byudjeti haqida rasmiy ibora: allocate funds/resources to + noun. Part 3 da ‘Who should pay?’ uchun mos. ‘Give money’ o‘rniga ishlating.

Namuna gap: Local authorities should **allocate funds to** restoring historic neighbourhoods.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

45 do irreparable damage

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tuzatib bo‘lmaydigan zarar yetkazmoq • *to cause harm that can never be fixed*

BAND 8 STORY

If visitors touch the ancient paintings, they can **do irreparable damage**, even if they don’t mean to. I once saw a tourist rub a fresco with his finger, and the guard looked absolutely horrified.

≈ **cause lasting harm** — uzoq vaqtli zarar yetkazmoq

≈ **damage beyond repair** — tuzatib bo‘lmas darajada buzmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Qaytarib bo‘lmas zarar haqida: do/cause irreparable damage to + noun. Part 3 turizm savollarida salbiy oqibatni kuchli ko‘rsatadi. ‘To‘ predlogini unutmang.

Namuna gap: Careless renovation can **do irreparable damage** to a historic building.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

46 wear and tear

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

vaqt o‘tishi bilan eskirish • *damage caused by normal use over time*

BAND 8 STORY

Millions of footsteps cause a lot of **wear and tear** on the old stone floors. That’s why some sites now limit visitors, and personally I think that’s a sensible, if sometimes annoying, solution.

≈ **gradual damage** — asta-sekin yemirilish

≈ **natural ageing** — tabiiy eskirish

Qachon ishlatiladi: Eskirish haqida: normal wear and tear/suffer from wear and tear. Sanalmaydigan ibora, ko‘plikda emas. Binolar, kiyim yoki mashina haqida ishlatsa bo‘ladi.

Namuna gap: Heavy crowds cause a lot of **wear and tear** on ancient monuments.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

47 strike a balance between

10/10 SPEAKING BALL

... o‘rtasida muvozanat topmoq • *to find a fair middle way between two competing things*

BAND 8 STORY

The real challenge is to **strike a balance between** welcoming tourists and protecting the site. If a city only thinks about profit, it’ll lose the very things people come to see.

≈ **find a middle ground** — o‘rta yo‘l topmoq

≈ **balance ... against ...** — ... ni ... bilan muvozanatlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikki qarama-qarshi talab haqida: strike a balance between A and B. ‘Between’ dan keyin ‘and’ keladi, ‘or’ emas. Har qanday Part 3 mavzusida ishlaydi, juda kuchli.

Namuna gap: Cities must **strike a balance between** development and conservation.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

48 knock down old buildings

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

eski binolarni buzib tashlamoq • *to destroy old buildings so something new can be built*

BAND 8 STORY

It makes me sad when developers **knock down old buildings** just to put up glass towers. In our city, a lovely old school was demolished overnight, and I still feel something is missing when I walk past.

≈ **pull down** — buzmoq (bino)

≈ **tear down** — yer bilan yakson qilmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(fe’l) kimnidir urib yiqitmoq (mashina) — A cyclist was **knocked down** by a car near the school.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Binolarni buzish haqida: knock down/tear down/pull down + building. Ular phrasal verb, ‘object’ ikki o‘rinda turishi mumkin: knock them down. Og‘zaki nutqda tabiiy.

Namuna gap: It’s a shame to **knock down old buildings** that took centuries to build.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

49 sustainable tourism

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

barqaror turizm • *travel that protects the place and its people*

BAND 8 STORY

I strongly believe in **sustainable tourism**: limited visitor numbers, local guides and fair prices. That way a historic town can earn money without losing its soul or its peaceful way of life.

≈ **responsible travel** — mas‘uliyatli sayohat

≈ **eco-friendly tourism** — ekologik toza turizm

Qachon ishlatiladi: Turizmni ijobiy yo‘nalishda taklif qilish uchun: promote/encourage sustainable tourism. Part 3 da yechim berishda ishlating, bu fikrni chuqurlashtiradi.

Namuna gap: **Sustainable tourism** is the best way to protect fragile sites.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

50 raise awareness of

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

... haqida xabardorlikni oshirmoq • *to help more people know about an important issue*

BAND 8 STORY

Schools can **raise awareness of** local history by taking pupils to historic sites. When I was twelve, one such trip made me fall in love with old buildings, and it changed my whole attitude.

≈ **spread the word about** — ... haqida tarqatmoq

≈ **educate people about** — odamlarni ... haqida o'qitmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ijtimoiy muammolarni hal qilish usulini aytganda: raise awareness of/about + issue. 'Of' va 'about' ikkalasi ham ishlatiladi. Part 3 da yechim berish uchun mos.

Namuna gap: Campaigns can **raise awareness of** the importance of heritage.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Describe and explain

1 Not only did + S + V, but + S + also + V

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

nafaqat ..., balki ... ham (inversiya) • *after 'Not only', the helper verb comes before the subject for emphasis*

BAND 8 STORY

The old caravanserai is lovely. **Not only did** it **protect** merchants from the desert, **but** it **also** worked as a market where news and ideas travelled. That's why historians love it.

≈ **Not just ..., but also ...** — Faqat ... emas, ... ham

≈ **As well as + -ing** — ... bilan bir qatorda

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikki ijobiy fikrni kuchaytirib aytish uchun. 'Not only' dan keyin yordamchi fe'l oldin keladi: Not only did it... (does/did/has). 'But also' ni unutmang. Part 2 da 1-2 marta ishlating.

Namuna gap: **Not only did** the mosque survive the war, **but** it **also** became a symbol of hope.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 What + S + V + is/was + ...

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

... narsa shuki (cleft: What I love most is...) • *a sentence that starts with 'What' to highlight the main point*

BAND 8 STORY

What I love most about this fortress **is** its quiet courtyard. When the tourists leave, the only sound is the wind, and I can sit there with a book for hours.

≈ **The thing I like most is ...** — Menga eng yoqadigani ...

≈ **What really impresses me is ...** — Meni chindan hayratga soladigani ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Asosiy fikrni ta'kidlash uchun gapni 'What' bilan boshlang: What + subject + verb + is/was + noun yoki clause. 'Is' dan keyin ot yoki 'that' gapi keladi. Nutqingizni tabiiy va kuchli qiladi.

Namuna gap: **What** struck me most **was** the sheer size of the entrance gate.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 the + N + in which / of which / whose + N

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ichida/... ning (predlogli nisbiy gap) • *a relative clause where the preposition comes before 'which'*

BAND 8 STORY

The madrasa **in which** my grandfather studied is now a small museum. Every spring I take my cousins there, and they love hearing about the teacher **at whose** desk their great-grandfather once sat.

≈ **the place where ...** — ... joy

≈ **the building that + clause** — ... bino

Qachon ishlatiladi: Binoga ma'lumot qo'shish uchun: the building in which/at which/of which + gap. Rasmiy uslub; og'zaki nutqda 'where' ham bo'ladi. 'Which' dan oldin predlog turishi - Band 8 belgisi.

Namuna gap: The fortress, **the walls of which** are three metres thick, has never been conquered.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 It is widely believed that … / be said to have been + p.p.

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

… deb hisoblanadi (passiv xabar) • *a formal way to say that many people think something is true*

BAND 8 STORY

It is widely believed that the tower **was built** by a famous architect from Persia. Nobody really knows for sure, but I love such stories because they add mystery to the place.

≈ **People say that …** — Aytishlariga ko‘ra …

≈ **be thought to have been + p.p.** — … bo‘lgan deb o‘ylashadi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Aniq bo‘lmagan tarixiy faktlar uchun: It is said/believed/thought that + gap yoki X is said to have been built. Rasmiy, ishonchli eshitiladi. Part 2 dagi ‘history’ bandida a’lo.

Namuna gap: The palace **is said to have been built** in just three years.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 so + adj + that / such + a/an + N + that

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

shu qadar … ki … • *a structure that shows a result of something extreme*

BAND 8 STORY

The ceiling was **so** beautiful **that** I forgot to take any photos. It was **such** an unforgettable moment **that** I can still describe every colour of the tiles with my eyes closed.

≈ **to such an extent that …** — shu darajada ki …

≈ **so much so that …** — hatto shu darajada ki …

Qachon ishlatiladi: Kuchli taassurot va natijani birgalikda aytish uchun: so + sifat + that, such + (a/an) + ot + that. Faqat ‘very’ dan ko‘ra boyroq. ‘Such’ dan keyin ot, ‘so’ dan keyin sifat keladi.

Namuna gap: The view was **so** stunning **that** we stayed until the sun went down.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 The + comparative, the + comparative

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

qancha …, shuncha … • *two comparative parts that show that one thing grows with another*

BAND 8 STORY

The more I learned about the fort’s history, **the more** I wanted to visit it again. By the end, I was collecting old books about it, which my mum found quite funny.

≈ **As + S + V, S + V + more and more** — … sari … ko‘proq

≈ **The longer …, the better …** — qancha uzoq bo‘lsa, shuncha yaxshi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikki jarayon birga o‘zgarganda: The more…, the more… / The older, the more valuable. Har ikki qismda ‘the’ bo‘lishi shart. Part 3 da tendentsiyalar haqida ham yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **The older** a building is, **the harder** it is to maintain.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 Having + p.p., S + V

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ni qilib bo'lgach (perfect participle) • *a shorter way to say that one action finished before another*

BAND 8 STORY

Having spent the whole morning in the museum, we were exhausted. But sitting in the courtyard with a cup of tea, I realised it had been one of the best days of my life.

≈ **After + -ing, S + V** — ... dan keyin

≈ **Once + S + had p.p., ...** — ... bo'lgandan so'ng

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bir ish tugagach, ikkinchisi boshlansa: Having + p.p., ... Ikkala gapning ega bir xil bo'lishi kerak. Part 2 hikoyasida ketma-ketlikni chiroyli bog'laydi.

Namuna gap: **Having visited** the old fort, I understood why locals are so proud of it.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 Had + S + p.p., S + would have + p.p.

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

agar ... bo'lganida, ... bo'lardi (3-shart, inversiya) • *an inverted way to say 'if' about the unreal past*

BAND 8 STORY

Had the villagers **not saved** the old gate, it **would have been** demolished in the 1980s. I always thank them in my head when I walk through it.

≈ **If + S + had p.p., S + would have p.p.** — Agar ... bo'lganida, ...

≈ **Were it not for ...** — Agar ... bo'lmaganida ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: O'tmishdagi 'bo'lmagan' vaziyat haqida. 'If' o'rniga 'Had' ni gap boshiga qo'ying. Salbiy shakl: Had we not... Rasmiy va kuchli, lekin hammasini shu bilan boshlamang.

Namuna gap: **Had** the roof **not been repaired**, the whole mosque **would have collapsed**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 Were it not for + N, S + would + V

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

agar ... bo'lmasa, ... bo'lardi • *an inverted conditional that shows how important something is*

BAND 8 STORY

Were it not for the volunteers, the old bathhouse **would** still **be** a pile of bricks. Their hard work gave the neighbourhood a new heart, and honestly, it gave me a favourite place to relax.

≈ **If it weren't for + N, ...** — Agar ... bo'lmaganida ...

≈ **But for + N, ...** — ... bo'lmaganida (rasmiy)

Qachon ishlatiladi: Kimdir yoki nimadir muhimligini ko'rsatish uchun: Were it not for + ot, ... would + fe'l. Hozirgi/umumiy vaziyatga mos. Og'zaki nutqda 'If it weren't for' soddaroq.

Namuna gap: **Were it not for** tourism, many monuments **would** be abandoned.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 No sooner had + S + p.p. than + S + V

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ulgurmasdan ... • *two events that happen almost at the same time*

BAND 8 STORY

No sooner had we **entered** the courtyard **than** the call to prayer began. The echo bounced off the walls, and I got goosebumps. It was pure luck, and I'll never forget it.

≈ **Hardly had + S + p.p. when ...** — ... ulgurmay ...

≈ **The moment + S + V, ...** — ... zahoti ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikki voqea deyarli bir vaqtda bo'lganini aytish uchun. 'No sooner... than' (that emas!). Gapdagi 'had' oldin keladi. Part 2 hikoyasida bir marta ishlating, ko'p ishlatmang.

Namuna gap: **No sooner had** we **arrived than** it started pouring with rain.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 It was + X + that + S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

aynan ... bo'lgan narsa ... edi (cleft) • *a sentence form that highlights one important detail*

BAND 8 STORY

It was during a school trip **that** I first fell in love with old buildings. Our teacher let us touch the ancient bricks, and from that moment on I wanted to know every story behind them.

≈ **It was then that ...** — Aynan o'shanda ...

≈ **It was ... who ...** — Aynan ... kishi edi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bir tafsilotni (vaqt, joy, kishi) ajratib ko'rsatish uchun: It was + vaqt/joy + that + gap. Kishi uchun 'who' ham bo'ladi. Qiziqarli hikoya boshlashga mos.

Namuna gap: **It was** the intricate tilework **that** I remember best.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 If only + S + had p.p. / I wish + S + had p.p.

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

qani edi ..., afsus ... (o'tmishdagi pushaymonlik) • *a way to talk about past regrets*

BAND 8 STORY

If only I **had taken** more photos! The light in that room was magical, and now I only have a blurry memory. Next time, I'll bring a proper camera and stay for sunset.

≈ **I regret + -ing** — ... ga afsuslanaman

≈ **I should have + p.p.** — ... qilishim kerak edi

Qachon ishlatiladi: O'tmishdagi afsusni bildirish uchun: If only/I wish + had + p.p. Hozirgi afsus uchun If only + past simple (If only I lived there). Part 2 oxirida his-tuyg'u bildiradi.

Namuna gap: **I wish I had visited** the palace before it closed for renovation.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

SAMPLE CUE CARD

Describe a historical building in your country.

Describe a historical building in your country.

You should say:

- where it is
- what it looks like
- what its history is
- why it is important

My 1-minute notes

- the Registan • Samarkand • three madrasas
- turquoise domes • intricate tilework • huge arches
- 15th-17th century • Ulugh Beg • restored
- first visit with family • breathtaking at sunset
- reason 1: national pride • symbol of our identity
- wrap-up: a window into the past • must-see for everyone

SAMPLE ANSWER • BAND 8

I • Intro (what and where)

I'd like to talk about the Registan, which is **an architectural masterpiece** in the heart of Samarkand. It's the building complex I'm proudest of in Uzbekistan, and every time foreign friends visit me, it's the first place I take them.

P • What it looks like

As for its appearance, it's made up of three huge madrasas facing a wide square. What I love most is **the intricate tilework** and the **turquoise domes**, which shine against the sky. **Not only did** the builders cover every wall in patterns, **but** they **also** made the giant arches perfectly symmetrical, so the whole place feels balanced and calm.

P • Its history

When it comes to history, the oldest madrasa **dates back to** the 15th century, when Ulugh Beg ruled. It's **said to have been** a centre of science and learning. Over the centuries it suffered from earthquakes and **fell into disrepair**, but a long restoration project managed to **restore** it **to its former glory**.

E • Reason 1

The main reason it's important to me is that it's **a source of national pride**. It's **part of our national identity**, and **having grown up** in Uzbekistan, I always feel strongly attached to it. I first went there with my family at ten, and the sight **took my breath away**.

E • Reason 2

On top of that, it offers **a window into the past**. **The more** I learn about the people who studied and taught there, **the more** I appreciate how much knowledge they shared. **Had** it **been** demolished, we **would have lost** a whole chapter of our history, so I'm grateful for everyone who protected it.

W • Wrap-up

So, all in all, the Registan is more than a tourist hotspot for me. It **left a lasting impression** on my childhood, and I'd recommend it to anyone. If you go at sunset and just **soak up the atmosphere**, I promise you won't forget it.

UPGRADE YOUR TALK

Tell a story, not a list

Instead of...	Say...
very old	steeped in history
very beautiful	breathtaking
a lot of tourists	swarming with tourists
repair it	restore it to its former glory
I liked it a lot	it left a lasting impression on me
important for the country	part of our national identity
tell people about it	raise awareness of it
detailed tiles	intricate tilework
very tall towers	towering minarets
big and impressive	an imposing structure
a beautiful front	a stunning façade
in good condition	well-preserved
full of decoration	ornate decoration
a museum that is alive	a living museum
ordered by a ruler	be commissioned by
in bad condition	fall into disrepair
it shows the past	bear witness to
a very important role	play a pivotal role in
a way to see the past	a window into the past
it made me excited	it sent shivers down my spine
take you to the past	transport you back in time
a thing to be proud of	a source of national pride
amazing	awe-inspiring
an attraction you must visit	a must-see attraction
pay to enter	pay an entrance fee